MA ENGLISH • SEMESTER 1

Block 1 — Unit 4: Methods of Teaching II

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING • M21EG01AC

Expanded exam notes | Simple teaching + developed argument

Based on the supplied SGOU self-learning material. Use the assigned primary texts for exact quotations and full scene or passage analysis.

The chapter in one sentence

Later ELT approaches foreground meaningful use, learner experience, supported participation, and critical reflection while retaining a need for purposeful attention to language.

Start with a picture

Knowing the parts of a bicycle is not the same as riding it, but riding also benefits from noticing and correcting what is not working. Language teaching similarly needs meaningful use and opportunities to improve form.

1. Communicative Language Teaching

CLT organises learning around meaningful communication, appropriate use, and interaction. Learners need a purpose, an audience, and some reason to exchange information. The teacher designs conditions, models language, facilitates participation, and provides feedback.

CLT does not mean grammar is banned or that all errors should be ignored. Fluency work may delay correction, while a focused phase addresses patterns affecting meaning or the objective.

A simple activity

Partners have different bus timetables. They must agree on a route and time. Missing information gives a reason to ask, clarify, and respond. The teacher checks both the agreed solution and the language used to reach it.

2. Linguistic and communicative competence

Knowing grammatical rules is not enough for choosing an appropriate request, keeping a conversation coherent, or repairing misunderstanding. Hymes’s communicative perspective broadens the question beyond internal grammar.

A common teaching framework distinguishes grammatical, sociolinguistic, discourse, and strategic resources. For example, a learner may know an interrogative form but still need to learn how to request help politely in a particular setting.

3. Task-Based Language Teaching

A task has a communicative purpose and an outcome beyond displaying a structure. A sequence can include preparation, task performance, planning or reporting, and language focus. Models differ; this is a useful pattern, not one compulsory script.

Example: groups select emergency supplies under a budget and justify the choice. The need to negotiate creates language work. The teacher later draws attention to comparison, reasons, or clarification forms that mattered during the task.

A task is not just any worksheet labelled fun. Specify the outcome and how language is necessary to achieve it.

4. Humanistic approaches

These approaches take feelings, agency, anxiety, and supportive relationships seriously.

- **Total Physical Response, associated with James Asher:** learners respond to understandable commands through action before extensive production is demanded.
- **Silent Way, associated with Caleb Gattegno:** teacher restraint, visual resources, and learner problem solving encourage attention and independence.
- **Community Language Learning, associated with Charles Curran:** supportive group interaction and a counsellor-like teacher role reduce some barriers to expression.
- **Suggestopedia, associated with Georgi Lozanov:** a relaxed setting and suggestion are used to encourage participation. Strong claims of exceptional learning speed need evidence and should not be assumed.

No approach suits every learner automatically. Physical action, public group work, music, or silence can require adaptation for access and comfort.

5. Krashen’s Monitor Model

The model includes acquisition–learning, natural order, monitor, input, and affective-filter hypotheses. The monitor refers to a proposed role for conscious knowledge in editing when conditions permit. Input is often summarised as i+1: language understood with a manageable stretch beyond current competence.

These are influential hypotheses, not direct measurements available from a quick classroom glance. Comprehensible exposure matters, but instruction should also consider interaction, output, feedback, and explicit attention to form.

6. Critical pedagogy and postmethod reflection

Critical pedagogy, associated with Paulo Freire, questions passive “banking” models of instruction and asks whose experiences and language count. Dialogue and reflection link learning with social conditions. It should not become a demand that learners repeat the teacher’s political opinions.

Postmethod work, associated with Kumaravadivelu, asks teachers to respond to particular contexts, develop practical judgement, and consider the wider possibilities and inequalities of

education. It does not mean abandoning planning or evidence.

Quick check

1. Does CLT forbid grammar? **No.**
2. What distinguishes a task from a display drill? **A meaningful outcome and need to communicate.**
3. Is i+1 an exact classroom score? **No.**

Build an exam answer

1. State a meaningful objective and learner context.
2. Create a real information gap or task outcome.
3. Explain competence beyond grammar.
4. Justify support and feedback through theory.
5. Evaluate access, assumptions, and evidence of success.

Common mistake to avoid

Do not equate communicative teaching with unplanned conversation, treat hypotheses as settled laws, or turn critical pedagogy into ideological obedience.

Developed exam discussion

Practice question

Design a communicative lesson and explain how theory informs its choices without becoming a rigid recipe.

Explain the argument in fuller paragraphs

A communicative lesson begins with a meaningful objective, such as planning a journey that satisfies several constraints. Preparation provides accessible input and useful expressions, while an information gap makes questions and clarification necessary. The teacher’s role is active in design and feedback even when learners control much of the talk.

A task-based sequence can develop that objective through performance, reporting, and focused reflection. The outcome must be distinguishable from the grammatical form being practised: a group chooses and justifies a workable route, not merely fills blanks with the correct tense. Observing the interaction supplies evidence of discourse and strategic competence as well as grammar.

Humanistic concerns inform access and participation. Learners may need preparation time, a smaller group, visual support, or alternatives to public performance. Krashen’s framework highlights understandable input and anxiety, but those concerns should be treated alongside output, interaction, and feedback rather than as a complete recipe.

Critical reflection adds questions about whose needs define the journey, what assumptions the materials make, and whether all learners can participate. This is not an extra slogan

attached after the activity. It can change the examples, resources, and available choices.

A strong answer explains these decisions and their limits. Postmethod judgement is principled when it connects context, activity, evidence, and revision. It is not simply the absence of a method name.

Use the discussion well

Answer the exact question, not every possible topic. Make one clear point per paragraph, support it with a textual detail or a relevant classroom example, and explain its significance. Check exact quotations against the assigned text. The discussion is paraphrase and guidance, not a quotation or a guaranteed exam answer.

Textbook assignment checklist

The following numbered prompts are retained from the unit for revision. Obvious source errors are discussed in the coverage review; a prompt's assumptions should not be accepted automatically. These are not predictions or complete written assignments.

1. The communicative approach is about developing the ability of learners to develop communicative competence. Show your familiarity with the approach with reference to teacher role, learner role, and an illustration of classroom activity.
2. TBL (Task-based learning), or TBLT (Task-based language teaching) is an approach in which learning revolves around the completion of meaningful tasks. Explain with suitable illustration.
3. Communicative competence is the tacit knowledge of a language and the ability to use it effectively. It's also the key to social acceptance. Explain.
4. In humanistic approaches to language teaching, learners are not seen as a full-time linguistic objects at whom teaching is aimed instead as individuals whose personal dignity, ideas, thoughts, needs and sentiments are respected. Explain with reference to Suggestopedia, Silent Way, Total Physical Response and Community Language Learning.
5. A teacher of English without a knowledge of Krashen's hypotheses cannot do a satisfactory job in the second language classroom. Explain with reference to the classroom implications of Krashens' hypotheses.
6. Critical pedagogy can encourage critical thinking and affect personal and social change. Illustrate highlighting the role of the teacher, the learner and classroom activities.
7. What is comprehensible input?
8. What is meant by competence in language teaching?